



Quill

Install and quick start · version 0.1.5

Quill is a writing assistant for the Mac, made for people who write English as a second language. It checks what you type in any app — Slack, Mail, your browser, Jira — and suggests fixes and rewrites right next to the text field.

Private by design. The spelling and grammar checks and the writing model both run on your own Mac. Nothing you write is sent anywhere: no accounts, no analytics, no cloud. The only download is the writing model itself, once, and Quill verifies that file before using it.

1. Install

- 1 Download **Quill-0.1.5-universal.dmg** from the Releases page: github.com/nicklasklasson/quill/releases.
- 2 Open the dmg and drag **Quill** onto **Applications**. Eject the Quill disk afterwards.
- 3 Open Quill from Applications. The first time, macOS says it can't verify the app. Click **Done**, open **System Settings** > **Privacy & Security**, scroll down and click **Open Anyway**, then confirm.
- 4 Quill now lives in the menu bar as a small feather, with no window and no Dock icon. A welcome panel appears in the top-right corner.
- 5 In the welcome panel, click a writing model to download it (see section 5). **Gemma 4 12B** is suggested on Macs with 16 GB of memory or more. You can keep working while it downloads.
- 6 Click into any text field, for example a Slack message. When macOS asks, open **System Settings** > **Privacy & Security** > **Accessibility** and switch on **Quill**. This is what lets Quill read and fix the field you're typing in.

If the badge doesn't appear after you've allowed Accessibility, quit Quill from the menu bar and open it again.

2. Everyday use: the badge

Click into any text field and a small round badge appears in its bottom-right corner. It follows you between fields and apps; when you leave a field it disappears, and it comes back when you return.

Click the badge, or press **⌘G** (Option-Command-G), to open the panel. Press it again, or **Esc**, to close it.

Quill skips password fields, search boxes and address bars, and doesn't look into Terminal or password managers.



Looks good. Nothing to fix.



Things to fix. The number of suggestions.



Checking. The ring spins while Quill looks closer.

3. Fixing what you wrote

The panel lists everything to fix, with the suggested change in blue. **Click the blue word** to apply it in the field, or click **Fix all**.

Spelling and grammar suggestions appear instantly as you type. When you pause, the writing model takes a closer look and adds what a spell-checker can't catch, such as "wit" for "with" or "you" for "your". Its suggestions have a dotted underline.

Add "word" to dictionary appears under flagged words. Use it for names, products and jargon, such as PaymentIQ, MID or Gammatrrix, and Quill and the writing model leave them alone from then on.

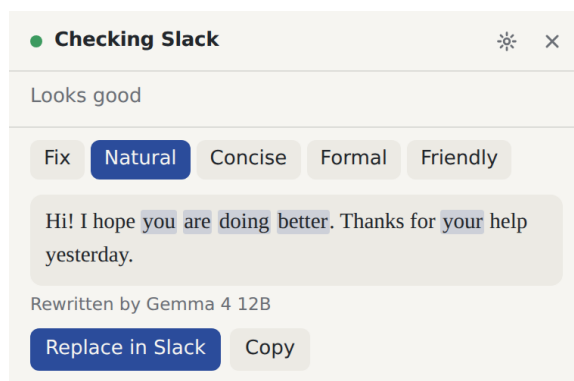
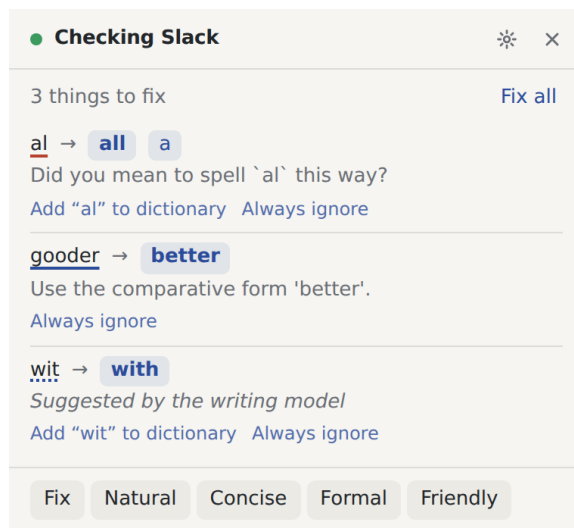
Always ignore hides that exact suggestion for good. Both lists are in Settings, where you can undo them.

4. Rewriting

The buttons at the bottom of the panel rewrite the whole text with the writing model:

Button	What it does
Fix	Corrects mistakes only and keeps your wording.
Natural	Reads the way a native speaker would write it.
Concise	Shorter, same meaning.
Formal	Polite and professional, for customers and stakeholders.
Friendly	Warm and relaxed, for colleagues.

Changed words are highlighted. **Replace in Slack** (or whichever app you're in) puts the result into the field; **Copy** puts it on the clipboard instead. The first rewrite after a break takes a little longer while the model loads.



Pausing and switching off

Right-click the badge for these options:

- **Pause in Slack for 1 hour or until tomorrow morning (06:00):** Quill leaves that app alone for a while, then picks up again by itself.
- **Pause everywhere for 1 hour.**
- **Don't check in Slack:** switches Quill off in that app until you turn it back on in Settings.
- **Turn off automatic checking:** no badges anywhere; the hotkey still works when you want a check.

The menu bar icon dims while anything is paused, and its menu lists each pause with a **Resume** item. **Pause everywhere** is in that menu too.

5. Choosing the writing model

The writing model is what catches mix-ups and writes the rewrites. It runs on your Mac and is downloaded once from inside Quill. Spelling and grammar checks work without it.

Model	Size	Best for
Gemma 4 12B	7.4 GB	Macs with 16 GB of memory or more. The newest and most capable.
Qwen2.5 7B	4.7 GB	The model Quill started with.
Qwen3 4B (light)	2.5 GB	8 GB Macs and Intel Macs.

Quill suggests one for your Mac. To check how much memory your Mac has: **Apple menu > About This Mac**.

A download can be paused and continues where it stopped. You can download more than one model and switch between them in Settings; each rewrite says which model wrote it. While loaded, a model uses roughly its download size in memory, and Quill unloads it after 10 idle minutes.

Welcome to Quill

Quill is in your menu bar

Click into any text field, in Slack, Mail or your browser, and a small badge appears in its corner. It shows a checkmark when the text looks good, or how many things to fix. Click it, or press `⌘⌘G`, to see the suggestions.

Everything runs on this Mac. Nothing you type is sent anywhere.

The writing model

Rewrites and the deeper check that catches mix-ups like “wit” for “with” use a language model that runs on this Mac. It’s a one-time download; spelling and grammar checks work without it.

Gemma 4 12B

Newest and most capable. Needs 16 GB of memory or more.

Suggested for this Mac

7.4 GB

Qwen2.5 7B

The model Quill started with (2024). Smaller than Gemma.

4.7 GB

Qwen3 4B (light)

Faster and smaller. Good on 8 GB Macs and Intel Macs.

2.5 GB

This Mac has 16 GB of memory. The download comes from Hugging Face and is checked against a fingerprint built into Quill before it is used.

Done

Settings

Open Settings from the menu bar icon or the gear in the panel. There you can change the hotkey, choose British or American English, skip text that isn't English (handy when you also write Swedish), turn the automatic badge or the background model check on or off, manage your dictionary, ignored suggestions, paused and excluded apps, and switch or remove writing models.

6. Updating to a new version

- 1 Quit Quill from the menu bar icon.
- 2 Download the new dmg from the Releases page and drag Quill to Applications. Choose **Replace**.
- 3 Open Quill. If macOS asks, click **Open Anyway** again as in step 3 of the installation.

Your settings, dictionary and downloaded model are kept.

If Quill keeps asking for the Accessibility permission after an update, open **Terminal**, run the line below, then open Quill and allow it again:

```
tccutil reset Accessibility app.quill.writing
```

7. If something doesn't work

What you see	What to do
No badge appears anywhere	Check that Quill is on under Privacy & Security > Accessibility , then quit and reopen Quill. Also check the menu bar menu: automatic checking may be off or paused.
No badge in one app	The app may be paused or excluded (see Settings). Some apps, such as Google Docs and terminals, don't let Quill read their text; press <code>⌘⌘G</code> there to use the scratchpad instead.
"Quill can't be opened" or "damaged"	Open it once via System Settings > Privacy & Security > Open Anyway . Don't move it out of Applications.
Rewrite buttons are missing	The writing model isn't downloaded yet. Download it from the panel or from Settings.
"Replaced by pasting"	Some apps don't let Quill change text directly, so it selects all and pastes. Your clipboard is restored afterwards.
The first suggestion is slow	The model loads after a break, which takes a few seconds. After that it's quick.

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